

SAUMYA AANCHAL

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EDUCATION

Patna Women's College, Patna University M.A (English Literature)	2020-2022
Vaniya Mahavidyalaya, Patna University B.com (Accounts Hons)	2016-2019
Prayag Sangeet Samiti, Allahabad Junior Diploma in Indian Classical Music	2005-2008

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Editor The Review of Democracy, Central European University	September, 2025 - Present
- Organize book panels and discussions on global democratic issues, coordinating with scholars and public intellectuals - Produce podcasts featuring academic interviews, managing outreach to international scholars and thought leaders - Contribute written articles and assist with editorial book reviews - Cultivate relationships with contributors across global academic and intellectual networks	
Script Consultant Panlingua Language Processing LLP	May, 2026 - July, 2026
- Providing consultation on Kaithi script usage, orthography, and historical forms. - Assisting with Kaithi script digitization and documentation efforts. - Reviewing transcriptions and reference materials for linguistic accuracy.	
Research Assistant Under the supervision of Dr. Anubha Anushree, Associate Professor, University of Delhi [Prime Minister Museum and Library funded Project]	June, 2025 - September, 2025
- Conducted archival research across state archives and library repositories to support academic project objectives - Collected and analyzed historical newspaper reports and primary source materials relevant to the research scope - Systematically documented, catalogued, and organized research data for analysis and reference	

CERTIFICATIONS

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- UGC NET 2026 - English
 - GATE 2025 - English
 - Digitising Kaithi Script - Unrealtek, Maithili Sahitya Sansthan, CoDin 2025
 - Understanding Research Methods - 5 week online course via SOAS University of London
 - Social Psychology - Online course via Wesleyan University Connecticut

PUBLICATIONS

Authored Book

1. Aanchal, Saumya. *Patna Kalam: Art, Memory, Revival*. Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage, May 2026.

Editor

1. Aanchal, Saumya. *Chhath Puja: Multidisciplinary Perspective on Faith, Culture and Community*. Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage, June 2026.

Book Chapters

1. Aanchal, Saumya. "The Memory of Water: Ritual Immersion, Riverbanks, and Ecological Memory in Chhath Pooja." *Chhath Puja: Multidisciplinary Perspective on Faith, Culture and Community*. Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage, April 2026.
2. Anushree, A. Aanchal, S. "Women in Crisis/Women as Crisis: The Gendered Aesthetics of Mithila Art During Covid-19." Cambridge Scholars Publishing. December 2026 (forthcoming)

Articles

The Battle For the Past: Populism and Memory Politics in Contemporary India

Article: The Review of Democracy, CEU Democracy Institute, Sept 2025

Creative Work

1. *The Sad Story of Life*. Co-author: 21st Century: Teenage Magazine. 2022. Daiso Publishing House.
2. *Somebody For You*. Co-author: Senora. 2022. The Quill House.
3. *People Only Start Caring When You Are About to Die*. Co-author: Delusion. 2022. The Quill House.

PROJECTS

Papers Presented

1. "REVISIONING SURPANAKHA THROUGH THE OUTLOOK OF FEMINISM: Volga's The Liberation of Sita and Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni's The Forest of Enchantments", second semester of M.A. - March, 2021
2. "LESBIANISM ON SILVER SCREEN: A STUDY OF THE INTERSECTION OF GENDER AND SEXUAL ORIENTATION IN THE INDIAN CINEMA", *Intersectionality and Gender: Texts and Contexts*, Department of English, Patna Women's College. - 26th and 27th March, 2022
3. "The Memory of Water: Ritual Immersion, Riverbanks, and Ecological Memory in Chhath Pooja", *Rituals and Traditions of Chhath Puja*, Department of Arts, Culture and Youth & INTACH, Buddha Smriti Park. - 11th October, 2025
4. "Postmemory and the Fractured Self in Farah Bashir's Rumours of Spring", *Crisis of Identity in Literature From a Post-Modern Perspective*, Second National Winter Language Conference, Sri Guru Gobind Singh College of Commerce, University of Delhi. - 15th-16th January 2026

Art

Kohbar Art Painting Exhibition

Lalit Kala Akademi, Patna – November 2024

- Created and showcased an original painting inspired by traditional Kohbar art on 3×4 canvas.

SKILLS

Qualitative Research • Research Design • Academic Writing • Organizational Skill • Digital Literacy including MS office • Effective Communicator • Project Management

LANGUAGE

English

Hindi

Maithili

Chinese (Basic Learner Stage)

REFERENCES

Dr. Anubha Anushree

Associate Professor, Department of English, Rajdhani College, University of Delhi

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Shri Bhairab Lal Das

Project Officer, Secretariat, Government of Bihar | Convener, Bihar State, Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage

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Dr. Richa

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